

Oppo Find X8

A truly balanced performer

The Oppo Find X8 makes bold promises: exceptional performance with MediaTek's cutting-edge Dimensity 9400 chipset, a display boasting breathtaking brightness and immersive visuals, and a Hasselblad-tuned triple-camera system tailored for photography enthusiasts. But does it hold up? Let's find out!

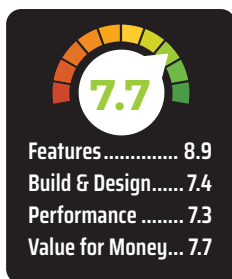
BUILD AND DESIGN

The Oppo Find X8 is a great example of thoughtful craftsmanship. The flat edges and the minimally contoured corners ensure a natural grip, even during prolonged use. Oppo's design philosophy, evident in what they are calling the "Cosmos Ring", which is present around the camera, is as visually appealing as it is functional, reducing the camera bump by 40 per cent compared to its predecessor, as claimed by the brand. The IP68 and IP69 certifications provide top-notch water and dust resistance. The Oppo Armour Shield further protects the device with reinforced glass and aluminium alloy, adding peace of mind for clumsy users. There's also a transparent silicon cover in the box; a rarity in the ever-skipper smartphone packages these days, but definitely a welcome addition. You also get a charger in the box, which is not seen in most flagships. Samsung and Apple, I am looking at you. The addition of an Alert Slider is a welcome touch, making it easy to toggle between silent, vibrate, and ring modes, especially handy in meetings or while commuting.

FEATURES, AI, AND UI

Oppo has managed to complement the hardware of this phone with ample features that will not leave you wondering how you can make full use of what is under the hood. And, as an iPhone user, I

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did not feel away from home once I started daily driving this phone when it came to the UI. There's also the Share with iPhone feature, which works on the same basic principle as ShareIt and other apps from back in the day. I did run into some hiccups during my time of using this app/feature, but I guess, that has more to do with Apple's ecosystem than Oppo's attempt to bridge the gap.

Coming to daily use, Color OS 15 offers a refined, feature-packed user experience. The new Luminous Rendering Engine ensures silky-smooth animations and transitions, with up to 18 per cent faster touch response, claims the brand. And in my time of use, getting hold of this 18 per cent increase was not possible to perceive, but I did notice the slight improvement in the snappiness of the phone here and there. But, the UI can feel cluttered due to the significant amount of pre-installed bloatware. From redundant apps to third-party promotions, these add-ons detract

from the otherwise smooth and refined software experience. Removing or disabling these apps can be tedious, making it a point of frustration for users who prefer minimalistic setups.

Coming to the AI side of things, the Oppo Find X8's AI-powered camera features are a real standout. I will talk more about this in the cameras section later. Tools like AI Unblur and Reflection Remover in the AI Photo Remaster suite are great for cleaning up tricky shots – they were useful, but like all AI-powered applications these days, there is still a long way to go for these to be flawless. Just to give you an idea, the phone did introduce some artefacts into the images when working the AI magic, over-smoothing the edges of the subjects in the pictures, giving it the tell-tale AI look.

On the productivity side, the AI Toolbox is packed with handy features. AI Summary can pull out key points from long articles, while AI Writer makes editing documents a breeze. Now this is something I would like to test out in the long term and update this review if I come across something significant.

DISPLAY

The 6.59-inch AMOLED display on the Oppo Find X8 is definitely one of its better features. When it comes to brightness, Oppo claims a peak of 16600 nits, which is plenty bright for outdoor use, even in direct sunlight. In my tests, the phone's peak brightness came to be 1546 nits, coming fairly close to the claimed numbers. The 3840Hz PWM dimming helps reduce flicker, so your eyes don't get strained during late-night Netflix binges. Watching HDR content is also a good experience here, with support for Dolby Vision, HDR10+, and HLG standards, and a peak local HDR brightness of 4500 nits. Although you'll need compatible videos to fully appreciate it. The bezels are really thin at just 1.45mm, making the screen feel immersive without being flashy about it.

PERFORMANCE

Synthetic benchmarks show the phone is no slouch: